

Guide: Render Mode Optimization

Detailed guide — English

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What Render Mode is

A long export/render (DaVinci Resolve, Final Cut Pro, Premiere Pro, After Effects, HandBrake and others) often competes with macOS background processes for the same disk and the same processor — this translates directly into slower or interrupted renders. Render Mode removes the 3 most common sources of contention with a single switch.

What it does exactly, under the hood

- Stops Spotlight indexing (`mdutil -a -i off`) — Spotlight continuously scans the disk, including NEW media files being written while you render, competing for read/write on the same disk.
- Pauses Time Machine (`tmutil disable`) — a backup starting right in the middle of a long export can saturate the disk and suddenly slow everything down, with no warning.
- Raises CPU priority (`renice -n -15`) for every detected render application currently running — the OS gives them higher CPU priority over other background processes.

Automatically recognized applications

The module isn't limited to DaVinci Resolve — it checks and optimizes ALL applications below that are running right now, simultaneously, not just the first one found (useful if, for example, you have Premiere Pro AND Media Encoder open at the same time):

- DaVinci Resolve
- Final Cut Pro
- Compressor
- Motion
- Adobe Premiere Pro
- Adobe Media Encoder
- Adobe After Effects
- Logic Pro
- Blackmagic Fusion
- HandBrake

The "Detected applications now" section on the Render Mode screen shows, with each app's official icon, exactly what the module would optimize if you turned it on right now — refreshed automatically every 5 seconds.

How to use it

- Open Render Mode in the sidebar and tap the switch — a SINGLE administrator password prompt for the whole chain of commands above.
- The green dot + "Render Mode ACTIVE" confirms it applied successfully.

- Start your render/export normally, from your editing app — Render Mode runs in the background and doesn't interfere with anything else.
- Once the render finishes, come back to this screen and turn the switch off — Time Machine and Spotlight return to normal automatically.

Important: Time Machine and Spotlight stay OFF as long as the switch is on, even if you close the render app in the meantime — turn it off manually when done, it does not re-enable itself.

What Render Mode does NOT do

- It does not stop automatic system updates or other apps — only Time Machine and Spotlight indexing.
- It does not change allocated RAM — for that, see the "Cleanup & RAM" module.
- CPU priority (renice) is not permanent — it clears automatically when the render app or the Mac restarts, no manual reset needed.

Master Control Studio Pro — github.com/gordasgdc/mac-master-control-pro